



Language of the pandemic

Glossary of all words and terms commonly used related to the novel coronavirus outbreak. <https://digit.in/May20-49>



Aussie corona slang

The Australian slang words that emerged during the pandemic, with examples of how to use them. <https://digit.in/may20-50>

Coronaviral

The autological adjective for things that have gone viral during the pandemic.

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CORONASPEEK

The UK has its own version of covidiot, called the morona. The French have come up with a specific and needlessly fancy word for the 14 day quarantine after being diagnosed – the quatorzaine. The German language is famous for having words for insanely specific things. Don't believe us? Just head over to r/german, make up something, and ask if there is a German word for it. Chances are, there will be. During the outbreak, the Germans came up with Coronaspeck, which is the fat that you accumulate during your days in quarantine. This is probably the result of hamsterkaufing, the tendency of hoarding much more food than you require. If countries got scored for coming up with words though, Australia would be on top. So defo strayan to come up with lazy short forms even when they have all the time in the world. Let us play a quick game and see if you can guess them all: Iso, sanny, magpie, bog roll, nigeling and the rona. Iso stands for isolation, sanny is sanitiser, magpie is for covidiot who panic and hoard stuff from supermarkets, bog roll is toilet paper (also called poo tickets), nigelling is social distancing and rona is the virus itself.



COOKING

With the aayahs taking a much deserved break, many people are suddenly finding themselves having to learn essential life skills, such as making food. They are also discovering the trials and tribulations of following YouTube tutorials without knowing the basics. What

in heavens is sauteing? How much volume really is 1 cup? How does one prevent rice from sticking to the sides of a cooker? What is the difference between chopping and dicing? And most importantly, how is it possible to cook in this heat? The answers to many of these questions can only be found by calling your mom, or posting on social media. One of the recipes shared by our readers, Aaruni Kaushik, which is proving to be incredibly popular is a firangi style pasta. The steps are heat olive oil and butter, add chilly flakes and garlic, fry it, fry onions, add salt, add carrot and shimla mirch, fry it again, add maida, brown it, add milk, add black pepper, oregano, basil and cheddar cheese, wait for cheese to melt, add boiled pasta, mix well and eat with roasted garlic-baguette.



CORONADVERTS

Around the world, brands are adjusting to the situation by stopping their regular campaigns and turning to new avenues. Facebook came up with the “we're never lost if we can find each other” ad, and Apple pushed out its “creativity goes on” ad, both of which feature poignant and uplifting scenes of the lockdown. Closer to home, Asian Paints came up with an innovative creative from the perspective of homes that were happy to be full, Nestle came up with a commercial that promised cooking to be an enjoyable experience instead of a chore, while Sony launched a Stay Home Stay Amazed campaign for its Pix channel. The template of all these ads seem to be the same. Stay home, stay safe, and buy our product.



LOCKDOWN SHAMING

This one is a bit of a quagmire, with the end result only making a bad situation worse. Lockdown shaming is the act of report-

ing those who flout lockdown rules to the authorities. The problem is that while there are covidiot and moronas in plenty, some using the opportunity to give fake reports, and as an outlet for settling old feuds with neighbours. In fact, in the UK, the police were bogged down by such fake and unnecessary reports, and had to appeal to the public to not use lockdown shaming as a weapon against the neighbours who they were troubled by. While the phrase has been coined in western countries, the activity takes place closer back home as well. The authorities are shaming those who go on joyrides in innovative ways such as questioning them on video and posting their silly answers on social media, conducting “aartis” in full public view, or the tried and tested method of a friendly tap with the laathi on the bum.



A-COMMERCE

Similar to the virtual experience economy, this is another one of those tech ideas that has been simmering for a long time, but suddenly got a boost due to the outbreak. A-commerce stands for automated commerce, and is the next step after e-commerce. The idea is that your fridge or larder should check what is out of stock and order it from the grocery. The entire process of making shopping lists, and going to the shop can be done away with. The need to tap through an app and make purchases can also be outsourced to machines. The deliveries can be managed by robots, or even drones. Concepts that were close to implementation got a push. China was among the first to start using drones to deliver food to those in quarantine. In Ireland, Manna Aero started using drones to deliver medicines, after the necessary clearances were fast tracked. We really cannot wait for machines to get so advanced, that psychographic profiles can predict when we are likely to get a craving for high protein ketogenic probiotic ice cream, and a drone drops from the sky as soon as we think of it. If that were possible, we would hand over our data right now. 